



UNDERSTANDING PREMENSTRUAL SYNDROME (PMS)

Premenstrual syndrome, or PMS, refers to a group of physical and emotional symptoms that occur in the days or weeks before a menstrual period. These symptoms usually begin about one to two weeks before menstruation and often improve once the period starts.

PMS is very common, and many people who menstruate experience at least one symptom during their reproductive years.

Common Symptoms of PMS

Emotional and behavioral symptoms

- Mood swings
- Irritability or anger
- Anxiety or tension
- Feeling sad or depressed
- Difficulty concentrating
- Changes in appetite
- Trouble sleeping

Physical symptoms

- Breast tenderness
- Bloating
- Fatigue
- Headaches
- Acne flare-ups
- Joint or muscle pain
- Digestive changes

What Causes PMS?

Possible causes include:

- Hormonal changes
- Brain chemistry changes, especially serotonin
- Sensitivity to hormonal fluctuations

When to Seek Medical Advice

It may be helpful to speak with a healthcare provider if PMS symptoms:

- Interfere with work, school, or relationships
- Cause severe emotional distress
- Do not improve with lifestyle changes

Key Takeaway

PMS is common and can involve both physical and emotional symptoms before a period. Although symptoms can be uncomfortable, many people are able to manage them through lifestyle changes, medication, or other treatments.

Bloom provides educational guidance only. Always consult with a qualified healthcare professional for personalized medical advice.

*Educational content informed by Cleveland Clinic. Premenstrual Syndrome. (2025)
American College of Obstetricians and Gynecologists. Premenstrual Syndrome (PMS).
Gudipally, P. R., & Sharma, G. K. (2023). Premenstrual syndrome. StatPearls Publishing.*